India's recognition of China came at an opportune time for the Chinese plans for Tibet. Deng Xiaoping, who was in overall charge of the south-western region, had written to the Central Committee on 1 January 1950, proposing to dispatch the Eighteenth Army into Tibet in the summer or fall of 1950. In his reply to Deng on 10 January 1950, Mao expressed his agreement, saying that India's recognition was favourable to the proposed plan. [4] Mao was on a secret visit to Moscow at the time, and used this opportunity to seek Josef Stalin's assistance on logistics for the planned Chinese invasion of Tibet. He wanted the Soviet air regiment to remain in China a while longer so that the authorities in Beijing could transport provisions to General Liu Bocheng's Second Field Army troops that were preparing the attack on Tibet. [5] Having secured Stalin's readiness to consider the matter, the Central Committee of the Communist Party of China formally issued orders for the 18th Army to enter Tibet in either the summer or fall of 1950. Tibet's fate was decided in early 1950.

The issue of Tibet also dominated the thinking within the Government of India, especially from the perspective of the boundary. India was aware of the efforts by the Nationalist government of Chiang Kai-shek to mount an international campaign in the mid-1940s to portray Tibet as a Chinese province, as well as its unwillingness to recognize the Simla Agreement of 1914, which India considered to have finalized its boundary with Tibet along the McMahon Line. In October 1947, the Nationalist government in Nanking informed the Indian Embassy of its wish to modify such agreements as were entered into between Great Britain and Tibet, including the Simla Agreement, 1914, that defined India's frontier with Tibet. In the same month, the Dalai Lama's government in Lhasa had also addressed a letter to India's Prime Minister seeking the return of 'all our indisputable Tibetan territories gradually included into